Executive Summary report.

Company: National Retail Company (SuperStore Sales)

Project: Business Intelligence & Interactive Dashboard Development

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Introduction:

The dataset used in this case study is from super store sales. The total entries are 9,994 with a duration running from January 3rd, 2014 to December 30th, 2017. The total sales are worth $2.297 M, total profit is $286.4 K, total orders are over 5K, average sales is $229.9 and the profit margin is 12.47%.

Key Insights:

- The west region had more sales ($ 0.73 M) and generated more profit ($0.11 M) compared to other regions.
- The consumer segment had more sales ($ 1.16 M) and generated more profit ($ 0.13 M) compared to other segments.
- Technology category generated more profit (42.77%) and furniture generated the least profit (6.44%) in the same period.
- The biggest profit generators are the office supplies category in the West ($ 52,609.85) and technology category in the East region ($47,462.04)
- The sales line graph shows a steady year over year growth from $484,267.50 in 2014 to $7,333,215.26 in 2017.

The Risks

- Severe regional and state vulnerability where the profit varies drastically across geographic markets indicating inefficiencies in local pricing or shipping e.g. the Central Region has a high sales volume ($501K) but a massive loss (a profit margin of 7.29%). The impact or risk is that the more items sold on counter – productive pricing rule, the more money the company losses.
- Furniture category accounts for over $742K in sales but achieves an overall profit margin of 2.49%. This results to a risk of unprofitable product categories.
- High discount promotional tactics are making revenue growth while severely damaging the net income. A total of 1871 transactions were sold at a loss amounting to $156,131.29.

Opportunities

- Geographic expansion in high margin regions. The West ($ 108.4K with a profit 14.95%) and East ($91.5K and 13.48% profit) are high performing. Reallocate the regional marketing spend towards West and East where the customer acquisition yields higher lifetime value and profit per customer.
- Turn around the furniture category. The furniture category generates $742K in sales but yields a weak 2.49% profit margin with tables running at 8.56% loss. Have a vendor renegotiation on

supplier pricing or adjust to catalog selection towards modular office furniture which lowers shipping weight and higher retail margins.

- Implement an automated pricing tier system within sales. Deep discounts (30% to 80%) are causing over $156K in loss across 1871 orders. By implementing the automated pricing tier system within sales can result to recovering even half of the lost profit from over discounted items and add approximately $78,000+ to the net profit.

Recommendations:

- Restructure the furniture category and subcategory. Increasing the base prices on high volume loss making sub categories (Tables and Bookcases) or introduce shipping and assembly surcharge for bulky goods Tables lose $17,725.48 (8.56%) despite doing $206K in sales while Bookcases $3,472.56. This will shift the furniture category from barely 2.49 % profit margin closer to the company’s average of 12.47%.
- Audit and fix underperforming regional markets. Perform a root cause audit of regional operations in tax/shipping and localized promotional campaigns in Texas, Ohio and Pennsylvania. Texas (-$25,729 profit), Ohio (-$6,971 profit) and Pennsylvania (-$15,560 profit) are the worst performing states. This shall stop regional revenue leaks and turn the negative margin territories into profitable sales channels.
- Shift marketing and sales outreach focus towards corporate and home office accounts rather than individual retail consumers. Home office (14.03% profit) and corporate (13.03% profit) are the noticeably higher profit margins than the consumer segment (11.55%). This shall drive higher lifetime consumer value with a more stable, recurring order flows and lower acquisition costs.